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System and methods for parity calculation in storage arrays

Abstract

A system may include a storage array comprised of one or more array member drives. The storage array may be partitioned into stripes of data across the one or more array member drives. In operation, a DMA controller may move source data from a processor memory and may write the data to an accelerator memory. The accelerator may perform a parity calculation and a DMA controller may write the parity result and the source data to at least one of the array member drives. The parity information may be used to reconstruct data in the one or more array member drives in the case of damage or loss of data.

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Background/Summary

PRIORITY

(1) This application claims priority to commonly owned Indian Provisional Patent Application No. 202311057216 filed Aug. 25, 2023, the entire contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference for all purposes.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(2) The present disclosure relates to systems and methods for parity calculations in a storage array of memory devices.

BACKGROUND

(3) In high-density data storage applications, redundant data may be stored to protect against any loss of information. Additionally, a block of data may be written across multiple drives, in what are called stripes, and parity information may be stored along with the data. In the event of a failure in one drive, the parity information may be used to recover any lost data.

(4) In one of various examples, a high-density storage application may be implemented as a Redundant Array of Independent Disks (RAID) array. In one example of a RAID array, multiple drives may be partitioned into stripes, and consecutive segments of data may be stored across different memory devices. In one of various examples, M individual drives, numbered 1 to M may,

respectively, be partitioned into N stripes, the stripes numbered from 1 to N. Individual drives may be partitioned into strips of data, each strip comprising a plurality of contiguous memory locations. One strip of data from each of the M individual drives may, in combination, comprise a stripe. Parity may be computed on a stripe-wide basis across the M drives. In this example, to compute the parity information for the first stripe, a parity calculation may be performed on the data in stripe #1 for, based on the data in the respective strip from each of drives 1 to M-1, and the result stored in drive M.

(5) A system processor, such as a central processing unit (CPU) may be used in calculation of the parity information. However, this may take system processor resources away from critical system operations and may result in delays in critical functions of the system processor.

(6) There is a need for a system and method to compute parity information in a storage array that offloads the processing overhead from the system processor.

SUMMARY

(7) The examples herein enable systems and methods for parity calculations in an array comprised of one or more array member drives.

(8) According to one aspect, a system includes a processor, a processor memory coupled to the processor, a storage array comprising one or more array member drives, an accelerator, an accelerator memory, and a communication circuit. The communication circuit may include a Direct Memory Access (DMA) circuit. The communication circuit may be coupled to the processor, the accelerator, the accelerator memory, and the storage array. The processor may instruct the communication circuit to move source data between the processor memory and the accelerator memory. The accelerator may perform a parity calculation on the source data stored in the accelerator memory. The DMA circuit may write the parity result and the source data to the one or more array member drives.

(9) According to one aspect, a method includes steps of: initiating a parity calculation by a processor, moving source data by a DMA transfer from a processor memory to an accelerator memory, the accelerator to calculate parity information, the parity information based on the source data moved to the accelerator memory. Additional steps may include storing the calculated parity information in a predetermined location in the accelerator memory, issuing notification from the accelerator to the processor, the notification to indicate the completion of the parity calculation. Additional steps may include issuing a command from the processor to one of a plurality of array member drives, moving the parity data from the predetermined location in the accelerator memory to one of the plurality of array member drives and moving the source data from the accelerator memory to at least one of the array member drives, and issuing a notification from one of the plurality of array member drives to the processor.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 illustrates one of various examples of a storage array device.

(2) FIG. 2 illustrates one of various examples of a system for computing parity information in a storage array.

(3) FIG. 3 illustrates a method for computing parity information in a storage array.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(4) FIG. 1 illustrates one of various examples of a storage array device **100**. Storage array device **100** may be comprised of four array member drives **101**, **102**, **103**, and **104**. Storage array device **100** illustrated in FIG. 1 may be comprised of four array member drives, but this is not intended to be limiting. Other examples may include more than four array member drives or may include fewer than four array member drives. The example illustrated in FIG. 1 may be a RAID array device, but

the device may be a storage array device utilizing another architecture, including but not limited to JBOD (“Just a Bunch of Disks”), SPAN/BIG and MAID (“Massive Array of Idle Disks”).

(5) Array member drives **101**, **102**, **103** and **104** may, respectively, be non-transitory memory devices, including but not limited to Dynamic Random Access Memory (DRAM), Non-Volatile Memory (NVM), Embedded Non-Volatile Memory (eNVM), or another type of non-transitory memory not specifically mentioned. Array member drives **101**, **102**, **103** and **104** may be, respectively, member drives of storage array device **100**.

(6) Array member drives **101**, **102**, **103** and **104** may, respectively, be coupled to memory bus **105**. Memory bus **105** may be coupled to processor **108**. Processor **108** may be a CPU or other processing device. Processor **108** may drive signals onto memory bus **105** to read data from array member drives **101**, **102**, **103** and **104**, and may drive signals onto memory bus **105** to write data to array member drives **101**, **102**, **103** and **104**.

(7) Memory bus **105** may be a Peripheral Component Interconnect (PCI) bus, a Peripheral Component Interconnect Express (PCIe) bus, a Universal Serial bus (USB), or another type of bus protocol not specifically mentioned.

(8) Array member drive **101** may be divided into strips. As one of various examples, array member drive **101** may include strips **111**, **121**, **131** and **141**. The example illustrated in FIG. **1** is not intended to be limiting. Other examples may include more strips or fewer strips than the number shown in FIG. **1**.

(9) Array member drive **102** may be divided into strips. As one of various examples, array member drive **102** may include strips **112**, **122**, **132** and **142**. The example illustrated in FIG. **1** is not intended to be limiting. Other examples may include more strips or fewer strips than the number shown in FIG. **1**.

(10) Array member drive **103** may be divided into strips. As one of various examples, array member drive **103** may include strips **113**, **123**, **133** and **143**. The example illustrated in FIG. **1** is not intended to be limiting. Other examples may include more strips or fewer strips than the number shown in FIG. **1**.

(11) Array member drive **104** may be divided into strips. As one of various examples, array member drive **104** may include strips **114**, **124**, **134** and **144**. The example illustrated in FIG. **1** is not intended to be limiting. Other examples may include more strips or fewer strips than the number shown in FIG. **1**.

(12) Storage array device **100** may be partitioned into horizontal stripes. First stripe **160** may include strips **111**, **112**, **113** and **114**. Second stripe **170** may include strips **121**, **122**, **123** and **124**. Third stripe **180** may include strips **131**, **132**, **133** and **134**. Fourth stripe **190** may include strips **141**, **142**, **143** and **144**.

(13) In operation, a block of data may be stored within a stripe. The block of data may be stored in multiple array member drives within the stripe. In the example illustrated in FIG. **1**, a first block of data may be partitioned and a first portion stored in array member drive **101** at strip **111**, the data labelled **A1**, a second portion stored in array member drive **102** at strip **112**, the data labelled **A2**, and a third portion stored in array member drive **103** at strip **113**, the data labelled **A3**.

(14) At array member drive **104**, strip **114** may store parity information based on the data stored in strips **111**, **112** and **113**, the parity information labelled **Ap**. Parity information may also be termed parity data. In one of various examples, the parity information may be computed as a logical XOR of the data stored in strips **111**, **112** and **113**. Parity information may be computed by processor **108**. In this manner, if any one of the array member drives **101**, **102**, **103** or **104** may be corrupted or damaged, the corrupted or damaged data may be recovered based on the data in the non-damaged array member drives. In this manner, first stripe **160** may store data and parity information.

(15) In the example illustrated in FIG. **1**, a second block of data may be partitioned and a first portion stored in array member drive **101** at strip **121**, the data labelled **B1**, a second portion stored in array member drive **102** at strip **122**, the data labelled **B2**, and a third portion stored in array member

drive **104** at strip **124**, the data labelled **B3**.

(16) At array member drive **103**, strip **123** may store parity information based on the data stored in strips **121**, **122** and **124**, the parity information labelled **Bp**. In one of various examples, the parity information may be computed as a logical XOR of the data stored in strips **121**, **122** and **124**. Parity information may be computed by processor **108**. In this manner, if any one of the array member drives **101**, **102**, **103** or **104** may be corrupted or damaged, the corrupted or damaged data may be recovered based on the data in the non-damaged array member drives. In this manner, second stripe **170** may store data and parity information.

(17) In the example illustrated in FIG. **1**, a third block of data may be partitioned and a first portion stored in array member drive **101** at strip **131**, the data labelled **C1**, a second portion stored in array member drive **103** at strip **133**, the data labelled **C2**, and a third portion stored in array member drive **104** at strip **134**, the data labelled **C3**.

(18) At array member drive **102**, strip **132** may store parity information based on the data stored in strips **131**, **133** and **134**, the parity information labelled **Cp**. In one of various examples, the parity information may be computed as a logical XOR of the data stored in strips **131**, **133** and **134**. Parity information may be computed by processor **108**. In this manner, if any one of the array member drives **101**, **102**, **103** or **104** may be corrupted or damaged, the corrupted or damaged data may be recovered based on the data in the non-damaged array member drives. In this manner, third stripe **180** may store data and parity information.

(19) In the example illustrated in FIG. **1**, a fourth block of data may be partitioned and a first portion stored in array member drive **102** at stripe **142**, the data labelled **D1**, a second portion stored in array member drive **103** at stripe **143**, the data labelled **D2**, and a third portion stored in array member drive **104** at stripe **144**, the data labelled **D3**.

(20) At array member drive **101**, strip **141** may store parity information based on the data stored in strips **142**, **143** and **144**, the parity information labelled **Dp**. In one of various examples, the parity information may be computed as a logical XOR of the data stored in strips **142**, **143** and **144**. Parity information may be computed by processor **108**. In this manner, if any one of the array member drives **101**, **102**, **103** or **104** may be corrupted or damaged, the corrupted or damaged data may be recovered based on the data in the non-damaged array member drives. In this manner, fourth stripe **190** may store data and parity information.

(21) The number of array member drives, strips and stripes illustrated in FIG. **1** is not intended to be limiting.

(22) FIG. **2** illustrates one of various examples of a system for computing parity information in a storage array.

(23) Processor **210** may be coupled to a communication circuit **250**. Communication circuit **250** may receive data from processor **210** and may transmit the received data to one or more circuits coupled to communication circuit **250**. Processor **210** may be coupled to processor memory **220**.

(24) In one of various examples, communication circuit **250** may include encoder circuits and decoder circuits to transmit and receive data based on one or more communication protocols. In other examples, communication circuit **250** may include direct wired connections between elements.

(25) Storage array **280** may be comprised of array member drives **281**, **282**, **283**, **284**.

(26) Array member drive **281** may include DMA controller **291**. DMA controller **291** may move data between accelerator memory **230**, processor memory **220**, and array member drive **281**. DMA controller **291** may write data to array member drive **281** and may read data from array member drive **281**.

(27) Array member drive **282** may include DMA controller **292**. DMA controller **292** may move data between accelerator memory **230**, processor memory **220**, and array member drive **282**. DMA controller **292** may write data to array member drive **282** and may read data from array member drive **282**.

- (28) Array member drive **283** may include DMA controller **293**. DMA controller **293** may move data between accelerator memory **230**, processor memory **220**, and array member drive **283**. DMA controller **293** may write data to array member drive **283** and may read data from array member drive **283**.
- (29) Array member drive **284** may include DMA controller **294**. DMA controller **294** may move data between accelerator memory **230**, processor memory **220**, and array member drive **284**. DMA controller **294** may write data to array member drive **284** and may read data from array member drive **284**.
- (30) Accelerator memory **230** may be coupled to communication circuit **250**. Accelerator memory **230** may include DMA controller **231**. DMA controller **231** may move data between accelerator memory **230**, processor memory **220**, and one or more of array member drives **281**, **282**, **283**, and **284**. DMA controller **231** may write data to accelerator memory **230** and may read data from accelerator memory **230**.
- (31) Accelerator memory **230** may be coupled to accelerator **240**. Accelerator **240** may write data to accelerator memory **230** and may read data from accelerator memory **230**.
- (32) Array member drive **281** may be a non-transitory memory device, including but not limited to DRAM, NVM, eNVM, or another type of non-transitory storage not specifically mentioned. Array member drive **281** may be coupled to communication circuit **250**. DMA controller **291** may control reading of data from array member drive **281** and may control writing of data to array member drive **281**.
- (33) Array member drive **282** may be a non-transitory memory device, including but not limited to DRAM, NVM, eNVM, or another type of non-transitory storage not specifically mentioned. Array member drive **282** may be coupled to communication circuit **250**. DMA controller **292** may control reading of data from array member drive **282** and may control writing of data to array member drive **282**.
- (34) Array member drive **283** may be a non-transitory memory device, including but not limited to DRAM, NVM, eNVM, or another type of non-transitory storage not specifically mentioned. Array member drive **283** may be coupled to communication circuit **250**. DMA controller **293** may control reading of data from array member drive **283** and may control writing of data to array member drive **283**.
- (35) Array member drive **284** may be a non-transitory memory device, including but not limited to DRAM, NVM, eNVM, or another type of non-transitory storage not specifically mentioned. Array member drive **284** may be coupled to communication circuit **250**. DMA controller **294** may control reading of data from array member drive **284** and may control writing of data to array member drive **284**.
- (36) Array member drives **281**, **282**, **283** and **284** may together comprise storage array **280**. The storage array **280** illustrated in FIG. 2 may be a RAID array, but this is not intended to be limiting. Array member drives **281**, **282**, **283** and **284** may comprise a different type of storage array.
- (37) In operation, system **200** may compute parity information and may store the computed parity information within storage array **280**. Processor **210** may initiate a transfer of data. Source data may be read from processor memory **220** and may be written to accelerator memory **230** by DMA controller **231**. Accelerator **240** may read the source data from accelerator memory **230** and may compute parity information based on the source data and may write the parity result in accelerator memory **230**. Accelerator **240** may issue a notification to processor **210** after the parity result is written to accelerator memory **230**. The notification may be an interrupt signal, a register write, or another type of notification not specifically mentioned. The parity result may also be termed parity information or parity data.
- (38) In operation, processor **210** may issue a command to one of array member drives **281**, **282**, **283**, **284**, the command to instruct the DMA controller in the respective array member drive to read data from accelerator memory **230** and write the data to at least one of array member drives **281**,

282, 283, 284. Accelerator memory **230** may contain a parity result computed by accelerator **240**. The DMA controller in the respective array member drive may control read of data from accelerator memory **220** and write the parity result to at least one of array member drives **281, 282, 283, 284**. The DMA controller in the respective array member drive may control read of source data from accelerator memory **220** and write the source data to at least one of array member drives **281, 282, 283, 284**. The parity result may also be termed parity data. The DMA controller in the respective array member drive may control write of data from processor memory **220** to storage array **280**.

(39) In one of various examples, processor **210** may issue a command to array member drive **281**. The command may instruct DMA controller **291** to move data from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **281**. Parity data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **281** by DMA controller **291**. Source data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **282** by DMA controller **292**. Source data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **283** by DMA controller **293**. Source data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **284** by DMA controller **294**. In another example, processor **210** may issue a command to array member drive **282**. The command may instruct DMA controller **292** to move data from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **282**. Parity data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **282** by DMA controller **292**. Source data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **281** by DMA controller **291**. Source data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **283** by DMA controller **293**. Source data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **284** by DMA controller **294**.

(40) In another example, processor **210** may issue a command to array member drive **283**. The command may instruct DMA controller **293** to move data from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **283**. Parity data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **283** by DMA controller **293**. Source data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **281** by DMA controller **291**. Source data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **282** by DMA controller **292**. Source data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **284** by DMA controller **294**. In another example, processor **210** may issue a command to array member drive **284**. The command may instruct DMA controller **294** to move data from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **284**. Parity data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **284** by DMA controller **294**. Source data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **281** by DMA controller **291**. Source data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **282** by DMA controller **292**. Source data may be moved from accelerator memory **230** to array member drive **283** by DMA controller **293**.

(41) In this manner, parity data may be computed and may be stored in any one of array member drives **281, 282, 283** and **284**. Source data may be stored in three of array member drives **281, 282, 283**, and **284**. Source data may be stored in a different array member drive from the array member drive where parity data is stored. Parity data and source data may be stored within a stripe of storage array **280**, the stripe comprising strips of array member drives **281, 282, 283**, and **284**.

(42) After the data is written from accelerator memory **230** to at least one of array member drives **281, 282, 283, 284**, storage array **280** may issue a notification to processor **210** to indicate completion. The notification may be an interrupt signal, a register write, or another type of notification not specifically mentioned.

(43) In the event of damage to storage array **280**, data within array member drives **281, 282, 283** and **284** may be reconstructed based on the parity information stored in respective array member drives **281, 282, 283**, and **284** and the source data stored in respective array member drives **281, 282, 283** and **284**.

(44) In operation, system **200** may implement a Peer-to-Peer DMA system to move data between

memory components, without limitation. In one of various examples, DMA controller **231** may move data between any of processor memory **220**, accelerator memory **230** and array member drive **281**. In another example, DMA controller **231** may move data between processor memory **220** and accelerator memory **230**. These examples of data movement are not intended to be limiting. DMA controllers may move data between any memory components in system **200**.

(45) FIG. **3** illustrates a method **300** for computing parity information in a RAID array.

(46) At operation **310**, a processor may initiate a parity calculation. The processor may be a CPU or other processor device.

(47) At operation **320**, source data may be moved from a processor memory to an accelerator memory. The movement of the source data may be performed by a DMA controller. An accelerator processor may perform a parity calculation based on the source data in the accelerator memory and may calculate parity information.

(48) At operation **330**, the parity information may be stored at a predetermined location within the accelerator memory. A notification may be sent to the processor after the parity information is stored within the accelerator memory.

(49) At operation **340**, the processor may issue a command to one or more array member drives, which as indicated above may respectively be storage drives, the command to instruct the one or more storage drives to move the parity data from the predetermined location within the accelerator memory and the command to instruct the one or more storage drives to move the source data from within the accelerator memory and to at least one of the array member drives.

(50) At operation **350**, the one or more array member drives may issue a command to the accelerator, the command to pull data from the predetermined location in the accelerator memory and transfer the parity information to at least one of the array member drives and to transfer the source data from the processor memory to at least one of the array member drives. A DMA controller may control the transfer of data from the accelerator memory to the at least one of the array member drives.

(51) At operation **360**, the one or more array member drives of the storage array may issue a command to the processor, the command indicative of completion of the move of the source data and the parity data.

Claims

1. A system comprising: a processor; a processor memory coupled to the processor; a storage array comprising one or more array member drives, the respective array member drives including a DMA controller; an accelerator; an accelerator memory including a DMA controller; a communication circuit coupled to the processor, the accelerator, the accelerator memory, and the storage array; and wherein the processor to instruct the DMA controller in the accelerator memory to move source data between the processor memory and the accelerator memory, and wherein the accelerator to perform a parity calculation on the source data stored in the accelerator memory and the DMA controller in one of the one or more array member drives to request the parity result, and the DMA controller in the accelerator memory to write the parity result and the source data to the one or more array member drives.
2. The system as claimed in claim 1, the one or more array member drives divided into strips, the strips comprising a plurality of contiguous storage locations within the respective array member drives.
3. The system as claimed in claim 2, the one or more array member drives grouped into stripes, the stripes comprising one strip from respective array member drives.
4. The system as claimed in claim 1, the DMA controller in the accelerator memory to move data between the processor memory and at least one of the accelerator memory and the one or more array member drives.

5. The system as claimed in claim 1, the DMA controller in the accelerator memory to write the parity result to the one or more array member drives.
 6. The system as claimed in claim 1, the one or more array member drives comprising four memory devices configured as a Redundant Array of Independent Disks (RAID) array.
 7. The system as claimed in claim 6, the four memory devices to store source data and parity information.
 8. The system as claimed in claim 1, the system to utilize Peer-to-Peer DMA communication between the processor memory, the accelerator memory and at least one of the array member drives.
 9. The system as claimed in claim 8, the system to write parity data and source data to one or more array member drives.
 10. The system as claimed in claim 9, the system to write parity data to one of the array member drives and to write source data to the remaining array member drives.
 11. A method comprising: initiating a parity calculation by a processor; moving source data by a DMA transfer from a processor memory to an accelerator memory, the accelerator to calculate parity information, the parity information based on the source data moved to the accelerator memory; storing the calculated parity information in a predetermined location in the accelerator memory; issuing notification from the accelerator to the processor, the notification to indicate the completion of the parity calculation; issuing a command from the processor to one of a plurality of array member drives; moving the parity data by a DMA transfer from the predetermined location in the accelerator memory to one of the plurality of array member drives and moving the source data from the accelerator memory to at least one of the array member drives; and issuing a notification from one of the plurality of array member drives to the processor.
 12. The method as claimed in claim 11, the plurality of array member drives comprising a storage array.
 13. The method as claimed in claim 12, the storage array comprising a Redundant Array of Independent Disks (RAID) array.
 14. The method as claimed in claim 12, the storage array divided into stripes, the stripes comprising one strip from respective array member drives.
 15. The method as claimed in claim 11, the plurality of array member drives respectively divided into strips, the strips comprising a plurality of contiguous memory locations within the respective array member drive.
 16. The method as claimed in claim 11, the calculated parity information based on an exclusive-OR computation of data in two or more array member drive locations.
 17. The method as claimed in claim 11, the method to utilize Peer-to-Peer DMA communication between the processor memory, the accelerator memory, and at least one of the array member drives.
 18. The method as claimed in claim 17, the method to write parity data and source data to the array member drives.
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